

Most "agentic" hiring tools **aren't**.

Voice AI became table stakes this year. Here's how to test whether a vendor's agentic claim is real.

 THE DEFINITION

Agentic means it **decides**. Not just replies.

A genuinely agentic AI observes context, makes a judgment call, and adjusts its next move without a human stepping in between. It asks a follow-up the candidate didn't expect. It decides how deep to probe on a specific skill. A tool that asks the same five questions to every candidate regardless of the answer isn't agentic — that's automation with a new label.

 THE REBRAND

Three vendors, two quarters, one word.

HireVue shipped a two-way voice interviewer scored against validated rubrics. **Ribbon** repositioned itself as a "hiring operator platform." **HeyMilo** raised fresh funding and launched three new AI agents on top of its voice product. Voice AI used to be the differentiator. Now every vendor has it — which means it isn't one anymore.

THE REAL TEST

Ask these before you believe the **claim**.

- 01** Does it ask real follow-ups, or read from a fixed script?
- 02** Can you configure how deep it probes on a given skill?
- 03** Does it hand off between screening and shortlisting on its own?
- 04** Is the scoring auditable, or a black box with no explanation?
- 05** Was it built for your candidates' accents, or adapted from a US/EU product?

WHAT A REAL STACK LOOKS LIKE

4 agents. One outcome.

Screening (adaptive voice interviews), simulation (Job Tryouts — candidates handle a real scenario, not a rehearsed answer), workflow (ATS handoffs on autopilot), and sourcing (candidate matching, launching next). None of them need a recruiter to manually stitch them together. That's the difference between an agentic platform and one clever interview bot.

— NOT A DEMO CONDITION

150 candidates. 5 days.

A Sri Lankan conglomerate ran that volume through the stack in a process that used to take 4-5 weeks manually. A major financial institution ran a pilot rigorous enough to secure board-level approval for an enterprise-wide rollout. A management trainee programme narrowed 460+ applications to a top-2% shortlist of 10 finalists.

"The process remained 100% transparent and data-driven."

YOUR MOVE

Stop taking the word **agentic** at face value.

Run the five-question test on your current vendor, or on the next one pitching you. If it can't answer yes to most of them, it's a marketing word — not an architecture.

Book a demo — see Talvin's four agents work on one candidate

Full breakdown → [link in comments](#) ↓